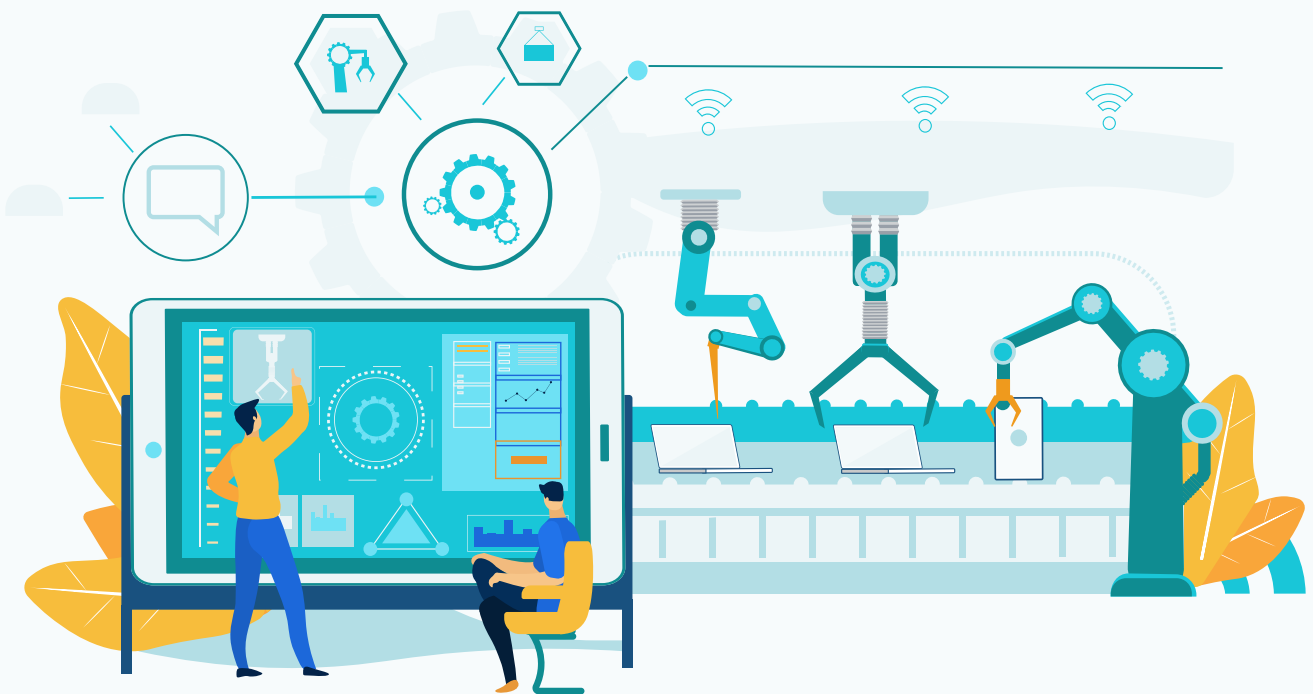


Change the Game with Transformative Innovation

All types of innovations have a place in business and economy. Having the right balance is important for all of them. The good thing is, when you have cash and jobs released from efficiency innovation, you can turn them towards disruptive innovation.



About the same time during the last year my kids were at home, courtesy school holidays, and were on the verge of being slammed by boredom. In the quest for entertainment my son and I decided to play chess.

For the first game I used simple tactics and, obviously, won. In the second round, I tried to make it difficult for him to win. He improved his game too, but eventually lost. The third time, I used even better tactics while he too raised his game. Yet, I won the third game too.

Before we could begin the fourth round, he said, “Let’s play something else.” Then he brought Snakes-n-Ladders, a game that levelled the playing field for both of us as we continued.

The disruptive innovation myth

A famous quote that is making the rounds in the industry is, “Uber didn’t kill the taxi business; limited access and fare control did!” People often use this quote to signify how disruptive innovation happens. Although somewhat cliché, let us roll with it.

With this type of quote, a typical response I have seen comes in two ways.

One camp of CXOs strongly believes that the right amount of incremental innovation can beat that level of disruptive innovation. They remain confident that incremental changes eventually pile up and can result in a big meaningful change. If you do all these small incremental changes you can fix many problems and stay on top.

The other camp, however, believes that incremental is not the